Please check the examination details below before entering your candidate information

Candidate surname	Other names

Centre Number	Candidate Number

Pearson Edexcel GCSE (9–1)

Thursday 11 June 2026

Morning (Time: 1 hour 30 minutes)

PAPER REFERENCE
1HI0/33

History

Paper 3: Modern depth study

Option 33: Conflict at Home and Abroad: the USA, 1954–75

You must have:
Sources/Interpretations Booklet (enclosed)

Total Marks
56

Instructions

- Use **black** ink or ball-point pen.
- **Fill in the boxes** at the top of this page with your name, centre number and candidate number.
- There are two sections in this question paper. Answer Questions 1 and 2 from **Section A**. From **Section B**, answer Questions 3(a) to 3(d).
- Answer the questions in the spaces provided — *there may be more space than you need.*

Information

- The total mark for this paper is 56.
- The marks for **each** question are shown in brackets — *use this as a guide as to how much time to spend on each question.*
- The marks available for spelling, punctuation, grammar and use of specialist terminology are clearly indicated.

Advice

- Read each question carefully before you start to answer it.
- Check your answers if you have time at the end.

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SECTION A

Answer both questions.

Study Source A below and then answer Question 1.

Source A

Source A: From a letter written by a US soldier to his family, describing his experiences on a Search and Destroy mission in South Vietnam, 1967.

We patrol through this thick jungle for days, carrying 60 pounds of gear in 100-degree heat. You can't see the enemy, but you know they are watching. Suddenly, a tripwire is hit and a homemade booby trap goes off, killing two of our buddies. There are no North Vietnamese soldiers to shoot back at, just empty jungle and suspicious villagers who refuse to speak to us. Out of frustration and fear, our guys burned down their thatch huts. We are fighting a shadow, and it is driving us crazy.

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1 Give two things you can infer from Source A about the difficulties faced by US soldiers during search-and-destroy missions in Vietnam. **(4)**

Complete the table below to explain your answer.

(i) What I can infer:

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Details in the source that tell me this:

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.....

.....

(ii) What I can infer:

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Details in the source that tell me this:

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(Total for Question 1 = 4 marks)

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2 Explain why US Search and Destroy tactics were unsuccessful in the years 1965–68. **(12)**

You **may** use the following in your answer:

- Guerrilla tactics
- Hearts and minds

You **must** also use information of your own.

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(Question 2 continued)

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(Question 2 continued)

(Total for Question 2 = 12 marks)

TOTAL FOR SECTION A = 16 MARKS

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SECTION B

For Question 3, refer to the Sources/Interpretations Booklet.

3 (a) Study Sources B and C in the Sources/Interpretations Booklet. **(8)**

How useful are Sources B and C for an enquiry into The effectiveness of US search and destroy tactics versus Vietcong guerrilla tactics?

Explain your answer, using Sources B and C and your knowledge of the historical context.

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(Question 3(a) continued)

(Total for Question 3(a) = 8 marks)

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(b) Study **Interpretations 1 and 2** in the Sources/Interpretations Booklet. **(4)**

They give different views about The effectiveness of US search and destroy tactics versus Vietcong guerrilla tactics.

What is the main difference between the views?

Explain your answer, using details and information from both interpretations.

(Total for Question 3(b) = 4 marks)

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(c) Suggest one reason why Interpretations 1 and 2 give different views about The effectiveness of US search and destroy tactics versus Vietcong guerrilla tactics. **(4)**

You may use Sources B and C to help explain your answer.

(Total for Question 3(c) = 4 marks)

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(d) How far do you agree with Interpretation 2 about The effectiveness of US search and destroy tactics versus Vietcong guerrilla tactics? **(16)**

Explain your answer, using both interpretations and your knowledge of the historical context.

Spelling, punctuation, grammar and use of specialist terminology will be assessed in this question.

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(Question 3(d) continued)

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(Question 3(d) continued)

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(Question 3(d) continued)

(Total for spelling, punctuation, grammar and use of specialist terminology = 4 marks)
(Total for Question 3(d) = 20 marks)

TOTAL FOR SECTION B = 36 MARKS

TOTAL FOR PAPER = 52 MARKS (+4 marks for SPaG)

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History

Paper 3: Modern depth study

Option 33: Conflict at Home and Abroad: the USA, 1954–75

Sources/Interpretations Booklet

Do not return this Booklet with the question paper.

Sources/Interpretations for use with Section B.
This booklet contains Source B, Source C, Interpretation 1 and Interpretation 2 for use with Question 3 on the question paper.

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Sources/Interpretations for use with Section B.

Sources for use with Questions 3(a) and 3(c).

Source B

Source B: From a report by a US Senate Subcommittee investigating the refugee crisis in South Vietnam, 1968.
Our heavy reliance on search-and-destroy operations and chemical defoliants has created hundreds of thousands of refugees. When we burn villages suspected of aiding the Vietcong and spray crops with Agent Orange, we are not winning the hearts and minds of the peasants. Instead, we are driving them directly into the arms of the enemy. The destruction of their ancestral lands has caused deep hatred of the US military.

Source C

Source C: From an interview with a Vietcong veteran, recalling the impact of US bombing and search-and-destroy missions, 1985.
The Americans had helicopters and napalm, but they did not know who the enemy was. When they came to our villages, they treated everyone as Vietcong. They burned our huts and killed our livestock. This made even the quietest peasants want to fight them. The American soldiers were terrified of our booby traps and snipers, so they responded with massive firepower that destroyed everything, making the people hate them even more.

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Interpretations for use with Section B.

Interpretations for use with Questions 3(b), 3(c) and 3(d).

Interpretation 1

Interpretation 1: From a modern historical study.
US tactics in Vietnam were self-defeating. The search-and-destroy missions and the widespread use of chemical defoliants like Agent Orange and napalm devastated the countryside. By destroying the homes and crops of the South Vietnamese peasants, these tactics alienated the civilian population and drove them to support the Vietcong, making a US victory impossible.

Interpretation 2

Interpretation 2: From a different historical perspective.
US tactics were militarily necessary to counter Vietcong guerrilla warfare. Search-and-destroy missions successfully killed large numbers of enemy fighters and disrupted their supply bases in the jungle. Without these aggressive operations, the Vietcong would have easily overrun South Vietnam. The tactics prevented a communist victory and gave the South Vietnamese government time to build its own forces.

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